when I ran onto the ground and embraced an emotional Yuvi, it was impossible to control my emotions. It was one of those life-changing moments and we wanted to live each and every second of it. While some players shouted and some cried, others were keen to go ahead with the victory lap in front of an ecstatic Wankhede crowd.

Virat and Yusuf Pathan lifted me onto their shoulders and someone gave me an Indian flag to wave. Being carried by my team-mates, waving the tricolour at my home ground, having won the World Cup – what more could I ask for? Life, to be honest, seemed complete. It was the greatest moment of my cricketing journey. Amidst all the euphoria, I remember telling Yusuf Pathan not to drop me. At this he said, '*Gir jayenge par aapko niche nahi aane denge.*' (We may fall down but we will not let you come down.)

It felt astonishing. It was a kind of satisfaction I had never experienced before. Cricket's greatest prize was finally ours. On our victory lap, I waved to the section of the crowd where I thought my children Sara and Arjun were sitting. I waved to them, hoping they would see me do so and come down. Luckily, they saw me wave and soon joined me in the middle. To be with my family while celebrating the greatest sporting moment of my life was special.

Anjali was not at the ground. She had stuck to her superstition of not coming to the stadium and she left home for the Wankhede only after we had won. She had a funny experience while driving to the ground. It was one of those nights when anything goes. Men and women were jumping on top of cars to celebrate and no one was objecting. The country had never seen anything like it. Just as Anjali was taking the turn to the Wankhede, a section of the crowd tried to get on top of her car to dance. At this point a couple of boys spotted her inside and said, '*Arre yeh unka gaadi hai, unko jaane do. Unke jaane ke bad humlog nachenge.*' (Hey, it's their [the Tendulkars'] car; let her go. We will dance after the car has dropped her off.) And they did exactly that. After Anjali was dropped at the main gate, they climbed on top of the car to dance, creating many dents, which we were happy to see as they brought back fond memories!

Something else that made the World Cup triumph really special was the fact that many of my team-mates dedicated the achievement to me. I felt overwhelmed. Once we had finished with the awards ceremony and the lap of honour, the scene of action moved to our dressing room. I opened the first bottle of champagne and subsequently made a point of